

Gantt Charts

IB Business Management revision sheet

A clear visual tool for planning, coordinating, and tracking projects.

Visual timeline

Task overlap

Progress control



What is a Gantt chart?

A Gantt chart is a time-based planning tool that maps project tasks against a calendar. It helps managers schedule work, see overlap, monitor progress, and spot delay risk quickly.

Quick facts

- Shows tasks, timing, overlap
- Best for launches, events, rollout plans
- Remember great overview, limited detail

Example: 8-week product launch plan

Managers use the bars to see timing, overlap, and live progress against plan.



Analysis and exam use

Strengths, limits, and the evaluation points IB markers like to see.

+ Strengths

- Turns a long project into one easy visual timeline.
- Makes overlap and deadlines easier to coordinate.
- Helps managers monitor whether progress is on schedule.
- Useful for communicating the plan to staff and stakeholders.

+ Limitations

- Needs updating when tasks shift or delays occur.
- Large projects can become crowded and hard to read.
- Does not identify the critical path or float directly.
- Timing may be visible even when resource bottlenecks are not.

Aspect	Gantt chart	Critical path analysis
Focus	Visual schedule and overlap	Logical sequence and total duration
Best use	Monitoring progress	Finding bottlenecks and float
Shows	start, finish, duration, progress	critical path, float, earliest/latest times
Main weakness	Can hide deeper dependency logic	Less intuitive as a quick visual overview

IB exam-ready evaluation

- 1 Apply it to a real project and explain why timing matters.
- 2 Analyse how the chart improves coordination or control.

Best judgement: use Gantt with CPA when project links

Strong final judgement

Use it when

deadlines, overlap, and communication

Watch out

for complex dependencies, shifting tasks

A Gantt chart is excellent for giving managers a clean overview of what should happen and when. In IB answers, the highest quality evaluation usually recognises that it is useful on its own for small or medium projects, but stronger when paired with critical path analysis for complex work.